

MERIDIAN FORGE / ANALYST DOCUMENT · WEEK 02

Business Case Recommendation

Angel Saucedo · Revision 5965

QA Control Review · A recommendation for the sponsor

1. Need, value and scope

Proposed project

QA Control Review of the affected QA cell

Business need

We need to identify a custodian or clear link to original source for four out of six retrieved record sets.

Expected value and beneficiaries

This would benefit QA and Engineering by giving them records they can trace. Also, Operations, as they need a reason to request later work.

Included work

The included work is as follows: review command-authorization ownership for the affected cell; inventory the controls used to schedule and retire its tests; document an evidence-preservation checklist; identify gaps and hand off a report for later decisions. The deliverables are as follows: one command-ownership record, one scheduling/retirement control inventory, and one evidence-preservation checklist.

Excluded work

The excluded work is as follows: restarting or operating MR-17, changing software or schedules, deleting or modifying original records, buying a replacement robot, selecting a vendor, and extending the review to other cells.

2. Feasibility and limits

Technical feasibility

The available tools support the review and read-only exports. Although, access to the necessary exports is still awaiting confirmation.

Operational feasibility

QA must request the records, custodians then search for said records, QA and Engineering work together to review retrieved records, and finally, Operations receives the summary. Roles mentioned need their availability confirmed before work authorization.

Cost and resource feasibility

Base estimate

Analyst 24 hours × \$55/hour = \$1,320

Engineering 12 × \$75 = \$900

QA 8 × \$45 = \$360

Operations 4 × \$60 = \$240

Total: 48 staff hours and \$2,820

What's excluded is: equipment purchase, software license or overtime allowance.

Schedule feasibility

The eight-business-day plan assumes that the exports arrive by day 3 and the review tasks overlap and has two business days of headroom against the ten-day limit.

Known constraints

The budget is \$3,000

Analyst 24 hours across days 1–8

Engineering 12 hours, no earlier than day 4

QA 8 hours during days 5–7

Operations 4 hours across days 1 and 8

Access to read-only exports is unknown.

Risks and assumptions

Things that may change estimate or delivery are denial of access, late exports (which delay Engineering), or QA shift reassignment. If access is denied, the team must revise the work or defer it.

3. Recommendation and next decision

Success measures and evidence

The sponsor will check delivery and later value by assessing plan estimates, supporting evidence, and measurable outcomes before commitment. The six-request baseline showed that staff was able to retrieve six records with an average of 10 minutes per request. Only two, however, came back with an identified custodian and clear link to the original source.

Recommendation

defer

Rationale and conditions

In this case, I believe that it is better to defer due to W02-S02, W02-S04, and W02-S05. S02 shows us the evidence-retrieval workload. Only two of six retrieved came back with an identified custodian and a clear link to the source. Four of six required a follow-up. Each of which, take an average of 10 minutes per request. S04 shows us the capacity, access, and operating limits. This source tells us that access to the necessary exports have been requested and not confirmed. Access that is denied must be revised or deferred which risks losing valuable time. S05 shows the estimate and success-measure sheet. The estimate states that the budget is \$3,000. The project is estimated to take about 40-60 hours. The base 48-hour estimate reaches 48 staff hours and \$2,820. Ideally, the team would finish within the estimated 48 hours, but if not, an estimated \$525 would be added to the budget. I believe that it's best to wait for missing information (the four follow-ups on S02) and get back to the sponsor with better estimates.

Next authorization or information step

Nia and Elias should be conferred with to confirm that they are able to examine three deliverables. Then, Mara must record their feedback to the sponsor in which the sponsor will make the final decision.

Source packet

W02-S01 · Request for a bounded review — Mara Ilyan · Production Operations Manager

W02-S02 · Evidence-retrieval workload — Nia Voss · Night QA Supervisor

W02-S03 · Proposed scope and current workflow — Mara Ilyan with Nia Voss · Review draft

W02-S04 · Capacity, access and operating limits — Elias Chen · Robotics Systems Engineer

W02-S05 · Estimate and success-measure sheet — Mara Ilyan · Planning estimate, not a quote

All case records and figures are fictional teaching data. This report does not authorize spending or operating equipment. The instructor evaluates the reasoning; completed fields are not a grade.